

SUBMACHINE

Frequently Asked Questions

Discord Server:

Jump on our Discord server to access our community of SubMachine experts.

<https://discord.gg/SxFJNexd4G>

NOTE: VERSION 24.2 and 24.2.1 of PREMIERE CONTAIN BUGS THAT PREVENT SUBMACHINE FROM WORKING. FOR MORE INFO CONTACT US VIA [DISCORD](#).

There are some Adobe API bugs in the latest versions of Premiere 24.2 and 24.2.1 that prevent SubMachine from working correctly. If you haven't already, it's best to turn off "Auto-Update" to avoid issues during a project until you're sure you're ready to update.

I'd recommend doing this immediately. In Creative Cloud go to Preferences > Apps to disable Auto Update for Premiere (And probably best to do After Effects as well).

If you've already auto-updated, I'd recommend rolling back to 24.1 if you'd like keep using SubMachine on a 2024 version, until the issue is resolved.

As Adobe states on their best practices page: "As with any software, we do not recommend updating when you are in the middle of a large project. The best time to update is when you're between projects or working on smaller pieces."

We are in constant contact with the Adobe engineers and they are aware of this specific API bug. At this stage we don't have a release date for any fixes. We'll let you know here once we get word that Adobe has resolved these issues.

If you have any questions or issues let us know via [Discord](#).

Top Question:

I can't find the "Individual Word Background" MOGRT featured in Premiere Gal's video.

This MOGRT has since been renamed "Karaoke" and is provide with SubMachine!

Top Question:

Where can I see all the different MOGRT styles?

Our [MOGRT Gallery](#) has animated examples of the MOGRTs we provide.

Top Question:

How do I create text on two lines instead of a single line?

Depending on which MOGRT you're using, the approach can differ slightly. One important thing to note is that if you want to have two lines, you'll need to have enough words, so before generating subs increase your "Characters Per Phrase" to a higher value like 40-50.



For **Karaoke, Block, & Tiktok** MOGRTs, you can follow these simple steps.

1. Go to the last MOGRT in a phrase (so you can see all words printed)
2. In the Essential Graphics Panel, go to the "Text Input" field and make a line break (Enter) where you desire.
3. Sync this change to the text input to the rest of the MOGRTs in the phrase with the **"Sync Text & Typeface"** tool. Please watch [this video](#) for more info on this tool.

For all other MOGRTs, there is an invisible text-box built into the MOGRT, so simply increasing your character per phrase value should result in double or triple lined text.

Top Question:

The changes I made to a MOGRT in After Effects do not seem to be applied when I create Subs.

If you've gone into After Effects and tweaked a MOGRT, you'll have to change the name of the MOGRT **within the Essential Graphics panel** to something different. If the name is the same, Premiere will instead grab the first result it finds, which is likely the MOGRT that does not contain your changes.

Top Question:

I'm syncing settings between mogrts, but they only are taking effect on every other line.

This is usually a side effect of having deselected the mogrts when you're syncing a large batch of mogrts. You should keep your timeline in the same state as it was when you clicked

'Sync' until it's completely finished.

Top Question:

Adobe Premiere Pro keeps crashing when I try to render or export a sequence that includes SubMachine mogrts.

So far this seems to happen most frequently with the Karaoke mogrt on low RAM, Mac OS Ventura using Premiere Pro 23.4.

We've been working with the Adobe engineers to get to the bottom of the crashing issue. It appears to be due to the font handling system and high-RAM machines seem to crash less frequently. This is a longstanding Adobe issue that is probably happening disproportionately frequently due to having so many .aegraphics on the timeline when using Submachine. At this point there is no direct fix. Adobe are working on a fix but it's a big one that could take several months. Some people are reporting success with using the most current beta version (23.6) so depending on where your project is at it might be worth updating. Please be careful with updating mid project!

We are also looking into optimising the workflows and mogrts on our end to try to reduce the chances of it happening.

If you could take a few moments to fill out this [Bug Report Form](#) it would be extremely helpful.

Pre-Purchase

What is SubMachine?

SubMachine is an extension for Premiere Pro that allows you to create & animate subtitles that are timed out word-by-word. This automates a time consuming process and opens exciting animation possibilities. It is currently provided with [7 free subtitle styles](#).

NOTE: You must have a valid, legal and paid for Adobe subscription. If you do not, SubMachine will not work.

How much does SubMachine cost?

There are two ways you can purchase SubMachine. A monthly Subscription that includes a free 7 day trial is \$8 a month, and a Lifetime one time purchase for \$150.

Will you be considering location based pricing?

We will definitely be looking at location based pricing. It is on my list of things to explore further.

SubMachine Languages:

We're confident that SubMachine is stable across English operating systems and English Adobe apps. There have been some issues with German OSs and Adobe apps that we are working on. If you use an OS, Adobe apps in a language other than English and you're keen

to help us make SubMachine better we'd love to hear from you at submachine@creativeworkflowsolutions.com.

SRT and MOGRT Languages:

If you'd like us to run some tests on using SRTs and MOGRTs/fonts in your native language send us an email at submachine@creativeworkflowsolutions.com. We've already run tests on Vietnamese, Danish and Hebrew SRTs.

Double Lined MOGRTs:

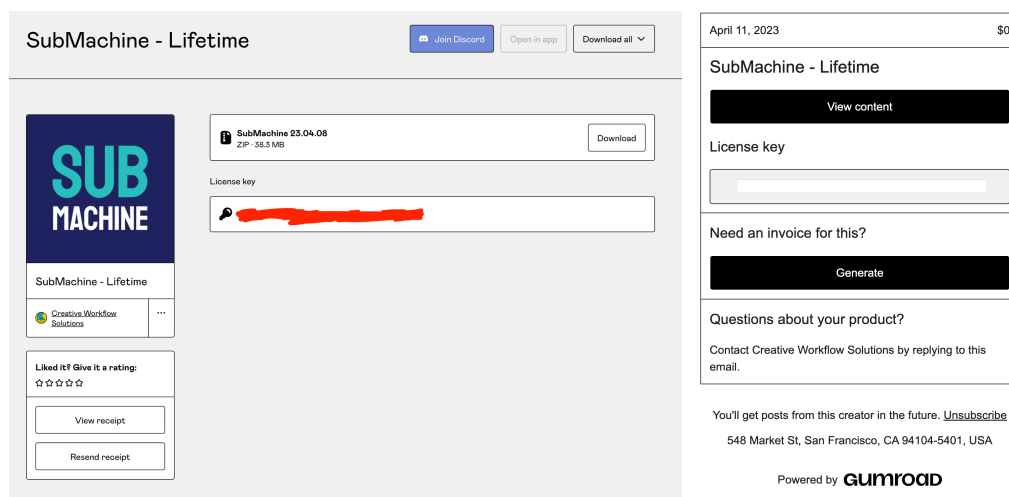
Whilst the SRTs used with SubMachine must be single lined the MOGRTs, designs and output do not need to be single lined. The output is defined by the MOGRTs so can be nearly anything you want within the confines of what's possible in After Effects and manageable for your computer. This [doc](#) shows the MOGRTs currently provided with SubMachine. These examples all show double lined output.

Download

Where is SubMachine?

You can find both the Subscription and Lifetime products at the [CWS Gumroad](#) and at [aescripts](#).

Gumroad provides a link (Download or View Content) to the content with the licence key in both the original screen directly after purchase and in the confirmation email.



If you purchased via [aescripts](#) The easiest way to install the SubMachine extension is by using the [aescripts +aeplugins manager app](#). To install a trial you can select 'Add Trial' from the 'Account' menu.

Alternatively, you can install using the [aescripts ZXP/UXP Installer](#).

You can also access their [knowledgebase here](#).

[Product Subscription FAQ](#)

[License Type FAQ](#)
[License Activation Management](#)
[License Code FAQ](#)
[Floating License FAQ](#)
[Floating License Server](#)

If you still need assistance, please [open a new support ticket from the aescrpts account you purchased the license from](#) and include screenshots so we are best able to assist you.

Installation - please watch this [video](#)

Mac: When I try to open the SubMachine .pkg it says that it's from an unknown developer?

In the Finder  on your Mac, locate the app you want to open.

Control-click (or right-click) the app icon, then choose Open from the shortcut menu.

Click "Open." The app is saved as an exception to your security settings, and you can open it in the future by double-clicking it just as you can any registered app.

Win: When I try to open the SubMachine .exe file it tells me "Windows Protected your PC" and won't let me install.

Simply click "Run Anyway" if the button is available. If not, you may need to click "Advanced" first.

Where is SubMachine in Premiere Pro?

In Premiere Pro go to the Window menu at the top, Extensions, SubMachine and the SubMachine window/panel will open up.

Login

When I went to log in it said the email address doesn't match the one on file?

Generally the "email doesn't match" error is an input, permissions, connection or Gumroad issue.

Input:

The email address that you signed up with does not match the email address that you've entered in SubMachine. This is most commonly due to capital letters or spaces before or after the email address. It's also worth checking that the license key has been added correctly too.

Permissions:

As mentioned in the FAQ doc this can be a permissions issue meaning that SubMachine isn't able to write the settings file to the known location. Close Premiere Pro. Go to /Users/{YOUR USER NAME HERE}/Library/Application Support on Mac or C:\Users\{YOUR USER NAME HERE}\Appdata\Roaming on Windows. Make sure you have read and write permissions for the Application Support folder on Mac or the Roaming folder on Windows. If things are operating correctly there should be a CWS_Settings folder at that location with a SubMachine_Settings.json file inside at that location. If that folder/file are not being created, SubMachine will not work. Once you have set the permissions correctly, open Premiere Pro and SubMachine, try logging in again and see if the folder/file are created correctly.

Connection:

If your internet connection is inconsistent SubMachine may not be able to access the Gumroad database to check and confirm your credentials.

Gumroad:

This is similar to the connection issue above in that SubMachine is not able to connect to the Gumroad database to check and confirm your credentials. This usually resolves itself but can take anywhere from minutes to hours with no idea of how long it's likely to take. It seems to be more prevalent immediately after people have purchased, implying that it takes some time for people to be added to the Gumroad database.

This can also be because you have been logged into a Gumroad account that uses a different email address to the one you signed up for SubMachine with. If you think this might be the case you can check your Gumroad account and SubMachine account and see if the emails match. If they don't match, try using the Gumroad account email address rather than the SubMachine email address to login to SubMachine. If you continue to have issues you can contact me via email and I'll run a check for you.

When I open SubMachine it says something like: ("You don't seem to have logged in on this computer before" or "SubMachine is currently unverified.")

When first opening the SubMachine extension you must navigate to the "Login" tab. There, enter in the email address you purchased SubMachine with and the licence key provided with your purchase.

Why when I try to login to SubMachine do I get a message that says "No IDs available."?

SubMachine is designed to be locked to 2 Adobe IDs, one for work and one for personal use. We felt this allowed for a reasonable level of flexibility. This error message usually means that the SubMachine account you're using already has 2 separate Adobe IDs attached so there are no more seats available. You can contact submachine@creativeworkflowsolutions.com if this does not seem correct.

How do I use SubMachine?

[-Full Video Walkthrough](#)

[-Written Workflow Documentation](#)

[-Tool-Specific Video Tutorials](#)

Create Subs

I can't find the "Individual Word Background" in the current version of Submachine?
That MOGRT has been renamed Karaoke and is still included in SubMachine

I get error 158, 159, 166 or 169 or any other number errors?

This can be for a number of reasons, including incompatible Premiere Pro, After Effects and mogrt versions, not selecting srt or mogrt files or long project names if you're on Windows. Are you using the correct mogrts for your version of Premiere?

On Windows it's often due to the Premiere Pro project file path being too long. Try moving the Premiere Pro project file to the Desktop, Documents or some other, shorter file path.

SubMachine appears frozen or nothing happens?

This can be because the SRT or Mogrt button has been used to open a Finder/Windows Explorer window but that window has not been closed/completed, which locks SubMachine.

If you use the SRT or Mogrt buttons make sure you complete the process by selecting an srt or mogrt from that window. Do not drag and drop from that window or the process will not be completed. If you wish to use the drag and drop functionality do so from an already open Finder/Windows Explorer window.

On Windows the Windows Explorer window may open in the background. You should see it appear as an orange outline/highlight around the Premiere icon in the task bar. This is a Windows issue that we have no control over at this stage.

When I select the Create Subs button nothing happens?

This is usually because the MOGRT you've selected is incompatible with your version of Premiere Pro and After Effects. We have provided MOGRTs created in After Effects versions 23 and 22 so they should work in Premiere Pro versions 23 and 22. Make sure you have selected the version that corresponds to the version of Premiere Pro that you are using.

You can check if the MOGRTs are compatible by importing the MOGRT into Premiere Pro and seeing if they work. If they are incompatible Premiere Pro will usually provide a popup alert explaining the issue.

We are working on creating MOGRTs for older versions of Premiere Pro and will let the community know when they are complete.

Can I mute the annoying ding sound?

You can modify/remove the actual audio file in the attached path if you're so inclined. The filename is "MA_OriginalSound_InfographicIdeas_1.wav" just make sure that anything you replace it with has that exact same name.

Macintosh HD > Library > Application Support > Adobe > CEP > extensions > com.pp.submachine > jsx > includes

You can also download a muted version from the [Discord community](#).

When I select Create Subs I get an error message saying “Unknown error while loading Motion Graphics template.”

This can be for a number of reasons but is often due to the Premiere Pro project file being nested too deep. Save as the project file to your Documents, Desktop folder or somewhere with an equally ‘shallow’ file path and try using SubMachine again. You can obviously save the project file wherever you want to but try to keep the file paths as short as possible.

Why am I seeing lots of gaps between subtitles?

This can be because you're using variable frame rate footage. In general the best practice is to transcribe variable frame rate footage to a constant frame rate codec like prores.

It can also be because the frame rate of the sequence and the MOGRT don't match. Try making sure your frame rates match. All the MOGRTs that come with SubMachine are available in the 7 most commonly used frame rates. If you need alternative frame rates you can open the MOGRT in After Effects, change the frame rate of the MOGRT composition, rename the MOGRT and re export the MOGRT. Renaming the MOGRT is vital so that SubMachine can identify the correct MOGRT to use in Premiere Pro.

Some users have also experienced this due to using Variable Frame Rate (VFR) footage like that shot on a phone. In general the best method of dealing with this is to transcode your original VFR footage to a prores codec and use that as the base for your SubMachine sequence. You can check if your footage is VFR in Premiere by checking the properties of the footage.

Can you do x, y, z subtitle style?

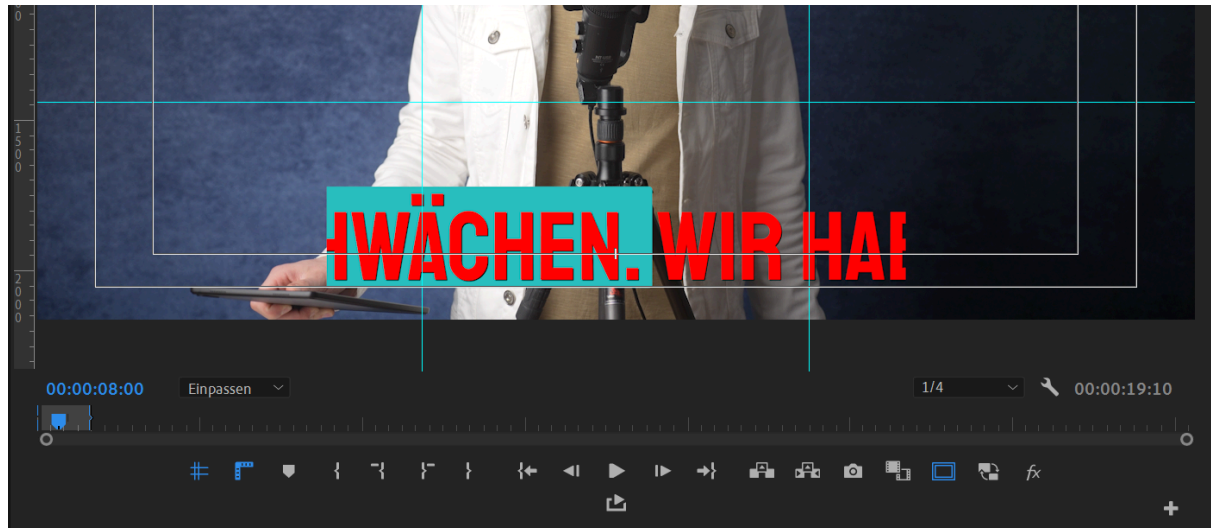
Send an image or link to our community on the [SubMachine Discord server](#) and we'll discuss! Our goal is for the SubMachine community to help each other build any type of animation you can dream of!

I've edited and exported a SubMachine MOGRT with my own fonts/colours but when I run Create Subs the MOGRTs don't seem to have changed?

When you edit a MOGRT it is vital you rename the MOGRT. SubMachine searches the Motion Graphics Template bin in Premiere Pro by name so if you haven't renamed your new MOGRT the old MOGRT may be found first and used by SubMachine. Renaming your

MOGRT solves this issue. You can also delete some or all of the old MOGRTs from the Motion Graphics Templates bin.

Why is my text getting cut off on the left and right hand sides when I enlarge the text to much?



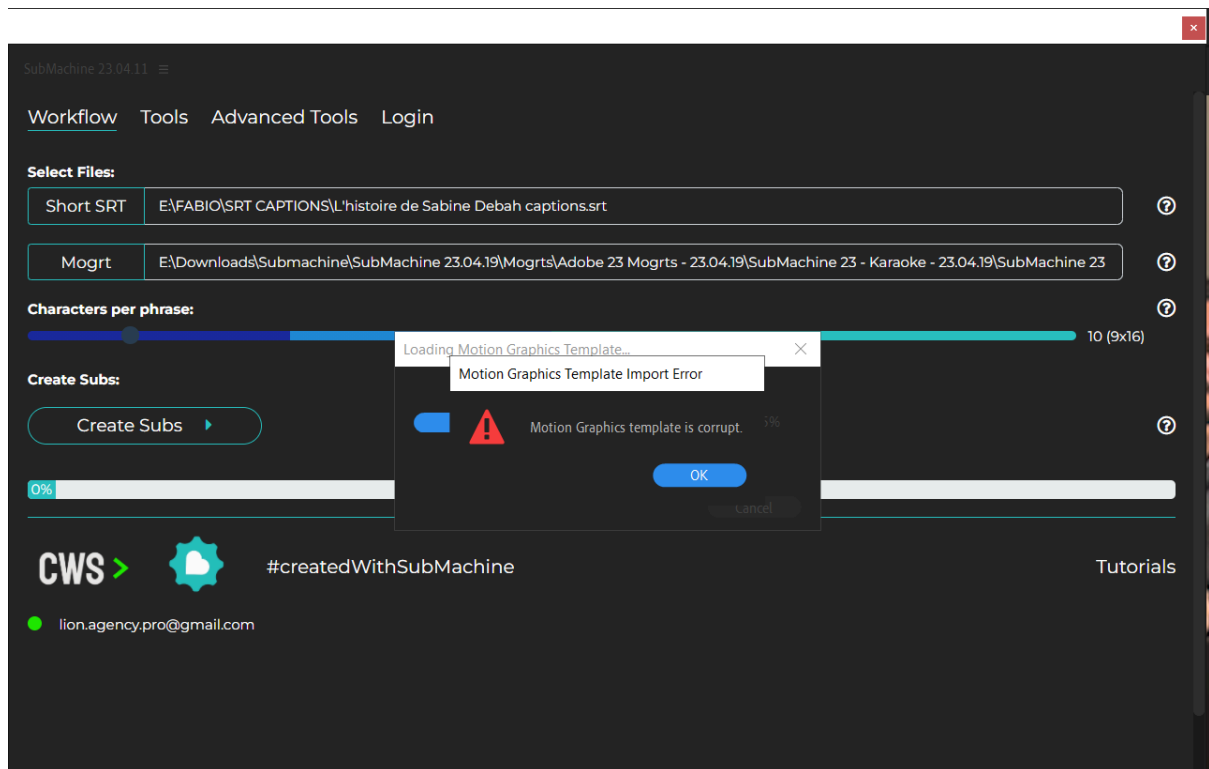
This is probably happening because you're in a 4K sequence. All of the SubMachine MOGRTs were created on 1920x1920 After Effects compositions so that they can be used on 1920x1080, 1080x1080 and 1080x1920 sequences in Premiere Pro without needing editing. We chose these as they are the most commonly used aspect ratios for social media. If you must use a 4K sequence I would recommend scaling the MOGRTs in the Effect Controls window and copying the attributes across to all the required MOGRTs. Alternatively you could use the Syn Position/Scale/Rotation tool in SubMachine but it will be slower.

Why am I getting tags like '<font color=' and '' in my mogrt text?

This happens when the SRT file hasn't been created in the correct format. Check the [Workflow Guide](#) or this [tutorial](#), or this [tutorial](#) for the correct format settings. If your SRT is not created in Premiere Pro you need to make sure it's not exported with any formatting tags.

Why does Premiere Pro say the mogrts are corrupt?

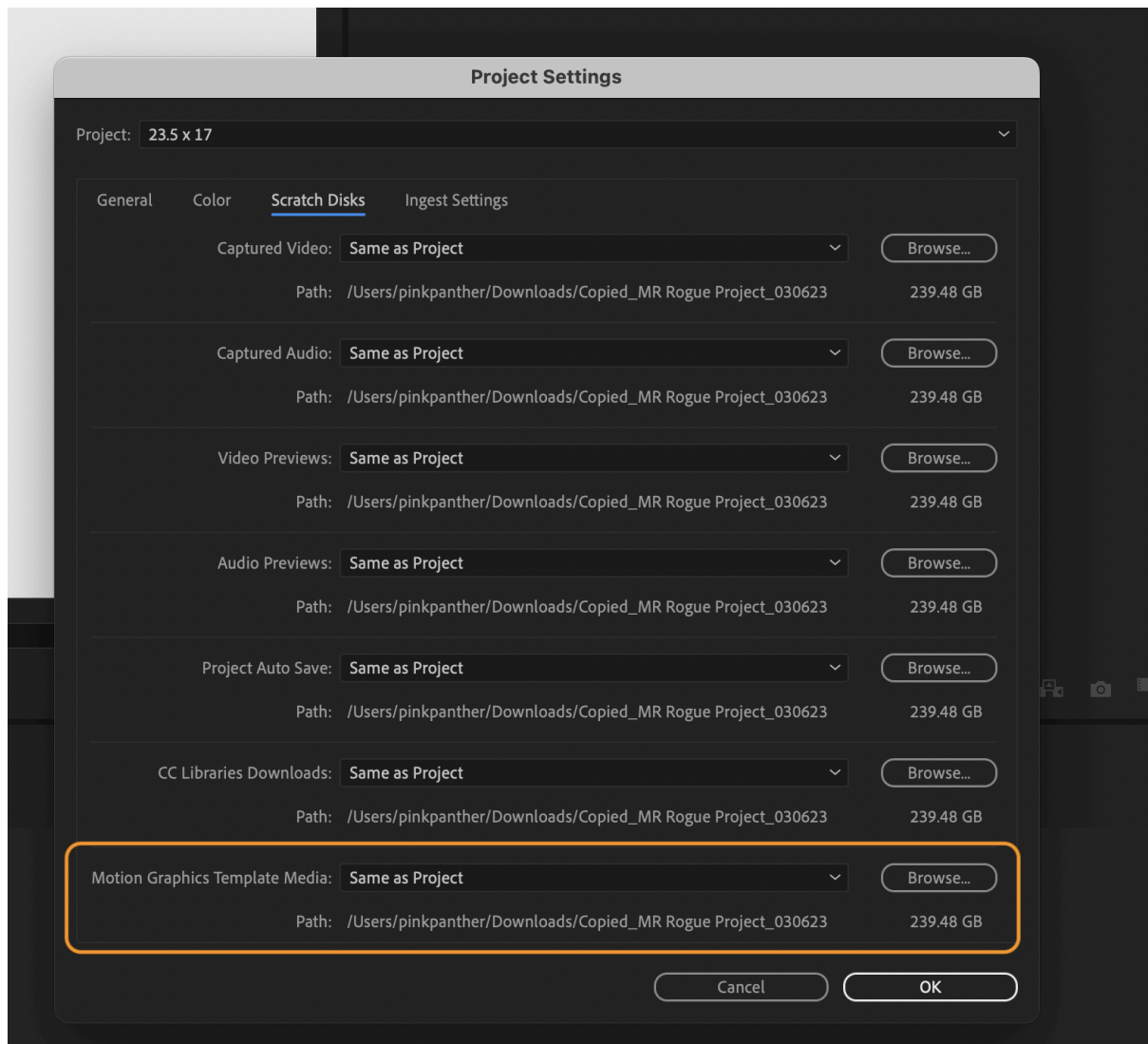
If you get an error message from Premiere Pro saying that the mogrts are corrupt it is often because on Windows is if the Motion Graphics Template Media Scratch Disk is set to a folder that has too long of a name or is nested too deeply. Windows has a 260 character limit on what it considers valid file paths.



When you add a Mogrt to the timeline, it unzips that Mogrt into that MGTM scratch disk folder that you set in Project settings so that the Project can see it as a dependency.

So if the MGTM Scratch Disk folder is nested too deep or in another set of containing folders with long names, then Windows will not allow the Mogrt to be unzipped and added to the project. This is an OS level limitation.

Our first recommendation is to change this scratch disk to be at the desktop level or some other extremely shallow folder level to see if that resolves it. If the scratch disk is set to Same as project as below you can also just move the Premiere Pro project file to an extremely shallow folder level.



Other none OS specific reasons why the Mogrt might show up as corrupt:

- there is a space between the end of the name of the mogrt and the .mogrt extension
- the .mogrt extension is in ALL CAPS (.MOGRT)

Another potential fix for a corrupt mogrt file is to open the mogrt file in your version of After Effects and re-export it.

To do this open your version of After Effects and go to File > Open Project.

Select your .mogrt file. You will be asked to select where you'd like to extract your new file to. Open the Essential Graphics panel. Make sure you have the correct composition selected. Our mogrts should only include a single composition to keep things as simple as possible but others may include multiple comps.

Rename the mogrt at the top of the Essential Graphics panel where it says Name. Use something that is unique and recognisable. Do not use all caps and make sure there are no spaces at the end of the mogrt name. Renaming is a vital step. If you don't rename your mogrt file SubMachine may not be able to identify your mogrt and is likely to select the original version instead of the new updated version.

At the bottom of the Essential Graphics panel select Export Motion Graphics Template ... to export the .mogrt file to a known location.

Try using this newly exported mogrt in Premiere Pro with SubMachine.

When I create subs my preview/program monitor goes black.

This has been reported and will hopefully be resolved in future Premiere updates. It's probably due to having so many aegraphics on the timeline and Premiere not being able to keep up with changes. Generally Premiere just needs a bit of a push in the right direction by enabling, disabling, toggling hiding etc of tracks/clips.

When I create subs some letters look weird, different sizes or different fonts.

This often due to full caches and clearing your caches and reopening the Premiere pro project will often resolve the issue.

The other common cause of this is conflicting fonts. Check that you only have one version of the font installed and/or reinstall the font and then reopen your Premiere Pro project.

When I create subs they come out with default text like “SubMachine: Easy Engaging Subtitles.”

This is often due to using the public beta versions of Premiere Pro. To resolve it you can use the current production ready versions and then open the project file in the public beta.

We've also seen it occur due to a lot of locked video tracks that don't allow SubMachine to create and locate the mogrts it needs. The solution to this is generally to make sure that you have 2 free, available and adjacent video tracks.

Edit Subs in Premiere Pro

I made a subtitle graphic look the way I want, how do I apply this to the other subtitles?

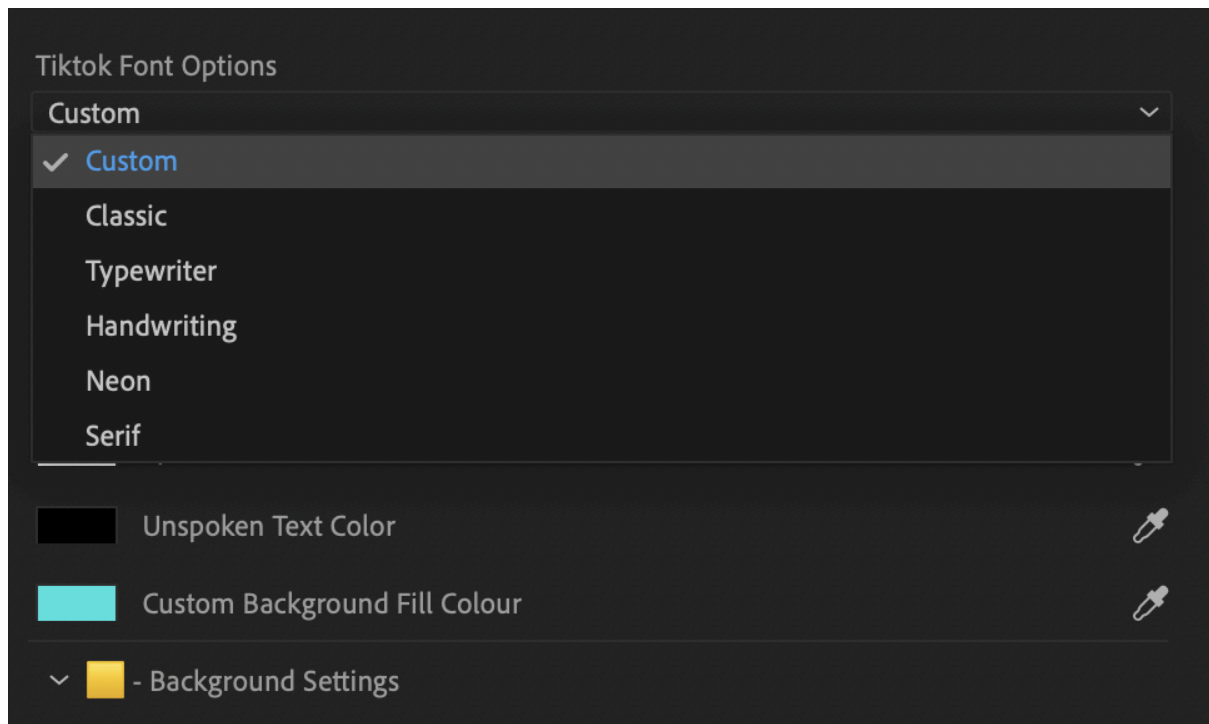
SubMachine has tools that allow you to Sync the changes you make from one .MOGRT to any other MOGRTs on your timeline. Watch this [short video](#) for an overview.

I am clicking “Sync All” with my playhead on the .MOGRT with the settings I like, why isn't it applying to all the other MOGRTs?

If you want to apply settings to all other MOGRTs on the timeline, you must select all of the MOGRTs you want the settings to be applied to,, including the one you're targeting.

I can't set a custom font in the TikTok mogrt.

If you wish to set a custom font in the TikTok mogrt you first need to select Custom from the TikTok Font Options dropdown menu. All of the other styles are connected to a specific font so they can't be altered. If you do wish to reset or alter those fonts you can do so via After Effects.



I'm trying to use the tools and nothing is happening?

Make sure your play head is somewhere in the middle of the clip, not at 0 or on the edge of the clip. If the clip you're trying to use is only 1 frame long you'll need to extend it to at least 3 frames or use another clip.

I did that, but some of my settings still did not Sync.

Currently, if you have changed a value away from its default value and synced it, it may not sync back to the default value. If this is occurring, you can go to the **Advanced Tools** tab in SubMachine and type in the name of the value you'd like to reset to default, being careful to type it exactly as written in the Essential Graphics Panel. Select the MOGRTs you'd like to reset the values on, and click "Reset Specific." You can also reset all values of selected MOGRTs with "Reset All."

I made a MOGRT look just the way I like, how do I save these changes to use in the future?

If you'd like to change the default settings of a MOGRT, you can open it in After Effects and make the same changes you want in the Essential Graphics panel in After Effects. [This video](#) features a great explanation of how to do that.

Edit Subs in After Effects

How do I create my own new looks in After Effects?

SubMachine is designed to make animating text easy for users in Premiere Pro. However, for users that are comfortable in After Effects, it opens the door for amazing custom animations you can integrate into our word-by-word workflow.

[This video](#) shows how you can edit mogrts.

[This video](#) from Premiere Gal covers a broad look at opening and tweaking MOGRTs in after effects.

[This section](#) of our full walkthrough covers a special character: ① you can integrate into your effects to make sure they are only applied to specific phrases.

An important concept to remember is that every MOGRT placed on the timeline is the *same* composition, so your animations need to keep in mind that the next word can sometimes come very quickly, sometimes only 3-5 frames. The best animations work even with rapid sequences of words.

To edit your subs in After Effects open your version of After Effects and go to File > Open Project.

Select your .mogrt file. You will be asked to select where you'd like to extract your new file to. Open the Essential Graphics panel. Make sure you have the correct composition selected. Our mogrts should only include a single composition to keep things as simple as possible but others may include multiple comps.

Rename the mogrt at the top of the Essential Graphics panel where it says Name. Use something that is unique and recognisable. Do not use all caps and make sure there are no spaces at the end of the mogrt name. Renaming is a vital step. If you don't rename your mogrt file SubMachine may not be able to identify your mogrt and is likely to select the original version instead of the new updated version.

Make any changes you'd like to the mogrt making sure to respect and maintain the ① Word Progression and ① Text Input properties.

At the bottom of the Essential Graphics panel select Export Motion Graphics Template ... to export the .mogrt file to a known location.

Test the newly exported mogrt in Premiere Pro with SubMachine.

Exporting Sequences

When I export my sequence it's all black.

This has been reported and will hopefully be resolved in future Premiere updates. It's probably due to having so many aegraphics on the timeline and Premiere not being able to keep up with changes. Generally Premiere just needs a bit of a push in the right direction by enabling, disabling, toggling hiding etc of tracks/clips.

Some users have also reported that exporting via Adobe Media Encoders allows the videos to export correctly.

Uninstalling SubMachine

On Windows we're finding that some users are needing to manually uninstall SubMachine before installing the new version. If you've already installed SubMachine, the fix is to go to "Add or Remove Programs" and manually uninstall SubMachine there, reinstall SubMachine, and hopefully you should be good to go!

You can also go to the extension folder (locations listed below depending on your OS) and delete the com.pp.submachine folder.

You can check your Mac extensions folder at:
/Library/Application Support/Adobe/CEP/extensions

You can check your Windows extensions folder at the folder paths below depending on your setup:

Win(x86): C:\Program Files\Common Files\Adobe\CEP\extensions

Win(x64): C:\Program Files (x86)\Common Files\Adobe\CEP\extensions, and C:\Program Files\Common Files\Adobe\CEP\extensions

Managing your SubMachine Licences and Cancelling SubMachine via Gumroad

You can cancel your SubMachine account at any time via your Gumroad account.

These Gumroad links might be useful:

<https://customers.gumroad.com/article/278-guide-to-memberships>

<https://customers.gumroad.com/article/192-how-do-i-cancel-my-membership>

<https://help.gumroad.com/article/247-what-your-customers-see>

<https://help.gumroad.com/article/282-how-do-purchases-work-for-my-customers>

I'd like to become a SubMachine Affiliate

If you'd like to become an affiliate send us an email at submachine@creativeworkflowsolutions.com.

Other

I have a problem not addressed by this guide!

Please consider joining our [Discord](#) to get the quickest help, or if that isn't an option for you, email submachine@creativeworkflowsolutions.com to reach the Dev team.